

1. We have no choice about past facts.
2. In the past, God had foreknowledge of our future actions.
3. We have no choice about the fact that God knows that in the future I will perform a certain action. (1,2)
4. If we have no choice about some facts, and those facts necessitate X, we have no choice about X.
5. God knowing that we will perform some action necessitates that we will perform that action.

C. We have no choice about whether we will perform our future actions. (3,4,5)

THE FOREKNOWLEDGE ARGUMENT

We'll soon consider some possible responses to Edwards' argument.

But before we do that, let's ask: can we come up with an argument similar to the Foreknowledge Argument which is based, not on foreknowledge, but on fate?

1. We have no choice about past facts.
2. In the past, there were truths about our future actions.
3. We have no choice about the truth that in the future I will perform a certain action. (1,2)
4. If we have no choice about some facts, and those facts necessitate X, we have no choice about X.
5. It being true that we will perform some action necessitates that we will perform that action.

C. We have no choice about whether we will perform our future actions. (3,4,5)

THE FATALIST ARGUMENT

Like the Foreknowledge Argument,
the Fatalist Argument is a serious
challenge to the reality of freedom of
the will.

The only changed premises are (1), (2), and (5) — and these all look plausible.

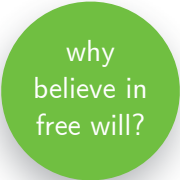
And of course one can't escape the Fatalist Argument by denying that God exists, or denying that God knows what we will do in the future. All we need is the existence of fate — of truths about the future.



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

the 1990s, the number of people with a mental health problem has increased by 50% (Mental Health Foundation 2000).

There is a growing awareness of the need to address the needs of people with mental health problems, and the importance of providing them with appropriate services. However, there is a significant gap between the current needs of people with mental health problems and the services available to them. This gap is due to a number of factors, including a lack of resources, a lack of training for health professionals, and a lack of awareness of the needs of people with mental health problems. This paper will discuss the current needs of people with mental health problems, and the services available to them. It will also discuss the factors that contribute to the gap between the current needs of people with mental health problems and the services available to them.

The first factor contributing to the gap is a lack of resources. There is a significant shortage of health professionals, particularly in the area of mental health. This shortage is due to a number of factors, including a lack of training opportunities, a lack of financial incentives, and a lack of awareness of the importance of mental health. This shortage of health professionals leads to a lack of services for people with mental health problems.

The second factor contributing to the gap is a lack of training for health professionals. Many health professionals do not receive adequate training in the area of mental health. This is due to a number of factors, including a lack of training opportunities, a lack of financial incentives, and a lack of awareness of the importance of mental health. This lack of training leads to a lack of services for people with mental health problems.

The third factor contributing to the gap is a lack of awareness of the needs of people with mental health problems. Many health professionals and the general public do not have a good understanding of the needs of people with mental health problems. This lack of awareness leads to a lack of services for people with mental health problems.

In order to address the gap between the current needs of people with mental health problems and the services available to them, it is necessary to take a number of steps. These steps include increasing the number of health professionals, providing adequate training for health professionals, and increasing awareness of the needs of people with mental health problems.

One way to increase the number of health professionals is to provide more training opportunities. This can be done by increasing the number of training places, and by providing financial incentives for people who enter the profession. Another way to increase the number of health professionals is to provide financial incentives for people who work in the area of mental health.

Another way to address the gap is to provide adequate training for health professionals. This can be done by increasing the number of training places, and by providing financial incentives for people who enter the profession. Another way to provide adequate training for health professionals is to provide financial incentives for people who work in the area of mental health.

Finally, it is necessary to increase awareness of the needs of people with mental health problems. This can be done by providing information to the general public, and by providing information to health professionals. This information can be provided in a number of ways, including through the media, through community organizations, and through health professionals.

2. In the past, God had

act in order.

some facts, and these facts

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6

1. We have no choice about past

5. God knowing that we will

the future will perform a

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whether we will perform our

C. We have no idea about

perform that action.



if we know the edge of our future

3. We have no other attributes

future actions. (3,4,5)

4. If we have no idea about

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Fatalist Argument by denying that

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a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predicto.

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

either.

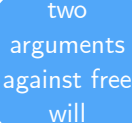
things as fate, then there is no free will.

and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

serious challenge to the reality of free will?



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

freedom that comes from fate.

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to

argument might be related to an argument

first let's think about how Edwards'

We'll shortly consider some ways of

for fatalsn.

responding to Edwards' argument. But

similar to Edwards' argument?

Suppose that someone did not believe in

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

Edwards' argument — but did believe that

actions. Could they give an argument

there were truths about all our future

replace reference to God's foreknowledge

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

God only shows up in premises (2) and

with reference to the being of truth about

our future actions.



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that if it is true that I will perform

(3, 4, 5)

2* In the past, there were truths about

some action, then I will prefer that

4. If we have no choice about p , and no

3 We have not the fact that

0 We have achieved what we

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,



5* We have noticed that the fact

perform a certain action (1,2)

all of our activities.

God knows that in the future I will

1. We have no direct facts.

then we have the choice about q.

will perform various actions.

The fatalist argument